

Unforgiveness Violates Grace

Open to Matthew, the eighteenth chapter. Hallelujah.

Lately, He has been running around and around in my spirit concerning what makes the infallible, valid, powerful Word of God perform for you, work, and change things.

One of the first revelations He brought was on lying. The predominance of that message on lying was this: if a person will compromise the truth on any scale, to any degree, then the devastating thing about not representing truth and lying is that you have no capacity to understand Someone who will not.

Much less can you understand an infallible God who has given us His Word to confess over problems, and the Word is so powerful it will change the problem.

If a person lies, compromises, bends the truth, and misrepresents the truth, then he has no comprehension of a God who will not.

You say, "Yes, I do."

No, you do not. You can say you do. You have some distant concept that He is God and, yes, He cannot lie. But you have no concept of Him. Because if you did, you would not lie if somebody cut your tongue off.

You would know your infallible God, who cannot lie and who speaks truth, and you would know that when you spoke the truth over the situation you are lying about, the final outcome would far outweigh the temporary remedy you brought by twisting the truth.

So you go and twist the truth.

"Why do I do that?"

I can tell you why you do it. Because you do not have the capacity to believe in an infallible God who cannot lie and who would eventually solve your problem. You do not have faith in Him. Why? Because you compromise and do not have the capacity to understand Someone who will not.

You say, "No, I do. He is my God."

No, you do not.

God told Kenneth Hagin for twelve years that he was supposed to be an evangelist.

He said, "Yes, yes, I know, God. I know."

God said, "No, you do not."

"No, I believe You, God."

"No, you do not. If you had believed Me, you would have gone full-time into evangelism."

If you really believed an infallible God and the use of His Word, you would stand up and say, "God has said, and I agree with Him." Instead we compromise and lie about it. If we do, it is only because we do not have the capacity to believe the final outcome of something we would have turned over to His hands.

"Yes, I do."

No, you do not, or you would have done it. Instead you solved it yourself by bending the truth, not even knowing the damage you brought.

So when we start exploring what makes the Word work, we go back and start nitpicking on the little foxes. The reason you think you can pass all of them up and make everything work is that you cannot.

I got into this revelation and thought He was going to drop this great big heavy thing on me about confessing the Word and what makes it work. Instead He backed up and started bringing this kind of thing.

The next thing He brought me to was Mark 11:23-25. These are mountain-moving Scriptures:

For verily I say unto you, That whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea...

Doubt not in your heart. The heart. Doubt not in the heart. Doubt not in the heart. You will have what you say with your mouth.

Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them...

Believe out of the doubtless heart. Doubt not in your heart. What things soever you desire, when you pray, believe. Doubt not in your doubtless heart. Then you will have whatsoever you say.

Now that is fun to stop right there. Who wants to go on to verse 25?

"God, why don't You give me some great revelation that no faith teacher ever had before about saying it? Why do You want me to wallow around in verse 25?"

Verse 25 says:

And when ye stand praying, forgive, if ye have ought against any...

So your heavenly Father, as you forgive them their trespasses, can forgive you your trespasses.

Glory to God. If verse 23 is true and verse 24 is true, then verse 25 is true. First He gives us the two exciting ones about moving mountains and the things you desire, believing and doubting not in your heart. Then He says, "If you have ought, forgive them their trespasses so your heavenly Father can forgive you your trespasses."

We need another verse in there for us who have not caught it yet. The next verse would be, "And then you release God to move your mountains and give you your desires."

So what do we do? We major in the part that is exciting: what things soever you desire. Eight people in a crowd of a hundred get their mountain moved. Who gets to testify? The eight people out of the hundred.

What do we do with the other ninety-two? They sit there and admire the eight.

"Their faith is an incredible thing."

You say, "Brother Hagin, how did you do it?"

He was a young Baptist boy on a bed of affliction, a teenager. About four diseases could kill his heart at any time. How did he do it? If you have heard anything from Hagin's camp, you have heard his testimony.

The first revival I ever preached, that was the only thing I knew: Kenneth Hagin's testimony. It took Kenneth Hagin an hour and a half to give it. It took me seven minutes. Then I did not know what to do with myself the rest of the time in front of that crowd of eight or nine people.

A young Baptist boy, afflicted with four diseases, came to Mark 11:24. Based on the Word of God, because he simply made a decision that he was going to believe every verse before he read the next one, he got to:

What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.

He said, "You know what I desire? To be normal like other teenagers, to play basketball and baseball, and to walk home and play. You said, 'What things soever you desire.' You know what I desire."

He got stuck right there for months. I guess he could not go to the next verse until he believed the one he was on.

In the next few months, it resulted in him getting out of bed one morning and walking into the breakfast table. His grandparents said, "Well, I guess you got you a miracle, didn't you?"

He walked out of it. Thank God, because of what happened to his spirit as a sixteen-year-old, he became a faith legend throughout the United States and many other countries, a man recognized for understanding and standing on the Word of God.

Thank God for it.

Then you see other men who branched out and moved in other areas. I have been in a man's meeting called Leroy Jenkins. I watched him hold microphones up to people's arms that were broken so you could listen to them crack and pop over the mic when he prayed.

I watched. It seemed like one of his favorite things was to get a person out of a wheelchair and have a couple of people hold him. Then he would demolish the wheelchair. He liked to do things like that, just kick it to pieces.

He said, "Now what are you going to do?"

One time he grabbed an old woman's cane from under her. I say old respectfully; that means wisdom. He grabbed her cane and was going to demolish it over his knee, but it was one of those kinds with a little iron rod in the middle.

He went, "Wonk, wonk," and finally just threw it.

"So what are you going to do now?"

She said, "That was my cane."

One woman rolled over, and he said, "How are you doing?"

She said, "Fine."

He said, "You are a liar. What are you doing in a wheelchair?"

Then you know what he did? He said, "If you are fine, walk." He dumped her out on the floor, just tipped it over and dumped her out.

Then she started cussing him. He said, "Well, I am not going to take this." He walked over and got two or three people healed and came back. Then she was lying there bawling.

She said, "I thank You already."

He just picked her up.

Like with Kenneth Hagin, incredible things happened. He was sixteen years old, got hold of the Word, and God descended upon him with angels and everything. He got healed. Since then he had three or four visitations from Jesus.

Leroy Jenkins had an arm that was dead and dying on him. It was turning purple with no circulation. He told his brother to kill the doctor if the doctor cut his arm off while he was passed out. So the doctor was afraid to cut his arm off. When Leroy came out, the doctor had just casted it up, and he had a dead arm. He was going to die.

He said, "I do not care. I would rather be dead."

His little Jewish Pentecostal housemaid said, "Hey, there is a man with a tent down the street."

Old Leroy thought, "What do I have to lose?" and went down to the tent.

Pow. The ceiling opened up, and according to him, the tent rolled back and Jesus came down. His arm just exploded alive, just like that.

Leroy Jenkins went back, sold his house, traded it all for a trailer that he said cost no more than the bottom of a swimming pool. He went out, got an old raggedy tent, and put it in somebody else's field just because it was open.

One of the first miracles under the tent was when he walked up to a woman who was blind and said, "The other day God put my whole arm back on. He put my whole arm back on. If He did that for me, He will heal you."

He prayed. Nothing happened.

So he stepped back and said, "God, You are the one who called me to do this. You heal her, or I will throw this mic down and quit right now."

He did not know any better. Her eyes opened.

The day after he got his miracle, he went down and caught a man by the hand selling pencils on a street corner. He said, "Yesterday God put my arm back on. If He did it for me, He will sure open your eyes." Then he took off running with the man down a dark alley. When they reached the other end, the man was seeing.

So what happened to these men, Brother Roberson? What happened to these Mark 11:23s and 24s that just enter in right off the bat?

And others fight and fight.

"How about me? I try it, and it does not work. I go broke trying to do a good work for God. I pray, and I am faithful. I prayed all year, and I know a guy who did not pray any, and he got it. I am faithful. This thing must be by grace. I am going to quit. I am going to quit praying and everything. If that fellow got it like that, I am going to quit and just lean on grace. Sin abounds; grace will much more abound."

Is anybody else having a good time?

Surely you are going somewhere with all this, Roberson. You bet your boots.

So what happens to these guys who enter in right off the bat while others fight and fight? Truly, this thing is by grace.

Anything we teach you here in the areas of revelation knowledge that results in transformation of your life - transformation, separation from the world - should result in that. Romans says, "Be not conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, to prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God."

When God goes to work, the revelation knowledge of the Word will supply power and change in your life for separation from the world.

Anything we teach in the form of revelation knowledge should result in that. We teach you to pray in the Holy Ghost. We teach you petitional prayer and the prayer of faith. Anything we teach you only instructs you in the use of the Word, in your positional truths, and in your relationship with Jesus Christ.

None of it is designed to replace grace, but to instruct you in the use of grace, the use of the Word, and the use of your standing of righteousness that you have received from Him. None of it was designed to replace grace. None of it.

When we are talking about forgiveness, there are very few things that will violate grace. Even being beaten up by the devil and pushed into a corner by the lusts of the flesh will not violate grace.

But unforgiveness will.

The reason is that you have taken the same principles - the unmerited, unearnable favor of God by which He extended His love toward you when you were unworthy and undeserving - and violated them.

You and I had nothing to bargain with. We were on the other side of a void, absolutely lost and undone. By the grace of God, by the mercy of God, He extended His blood across that void.

You undeserving thing. You had nothing to bargain with until mercy delivered grace into your hands. You stood up and took that grace and said, "Devil, I want you in hell to hear this. The unmerited, unearnable favor of God has been delivered to my doorstep by His mercy. I did not deserve it. I did not merit it. But now grace has been given to me. I am going to take that grace and approach His presence, the throne room of grace. I am going to ask God to forgive me based on that grace. He gave me that blood to bargain with by His mercy. I am going to ask Him to forgive me because mercy delivered blood to bargain with. I did not deserve it. I did not merit it. But I am forgiven."

I do not care what anybody does to you. It does not matter. He lumped it in one category and said to forgive your brother all. All. If you refuse to do so, you are in violation of the very principles by which you and I have been born again.

Because you violate grace, you hinder the moving of the Holy Spirit within your life.

Violation of grace in areas of unforgiveness is different from when you get caught in the lust of the flesh and hate yourself for it. You hate it. It might be gratifying for a short season as you are caught up in it, but you hate yourself for it. You wish you would not have done it. You kick yourself. You hate yourself the worst because you are so weak that you continue the offense time after time.

God hates it right along with you. He hates it right along with you. There is no use anybody else hating you any worse than you do yourself. He hates it right along with you, and He is right there every moment trying to get you out of it.

But when you start unforgiveness and hatred toward other people, it is hard to hate yourself for hating other people. In fact, in an area of self-exaltation, we begin to esteem ourselves.

"Yes, oh yes, I deserve much better treatment from that person, that institution, my employment."

Joseph deserved much better treatment than jail. Thank God it did not affect his attitude.

You may deserve much better treatment than what people are giving you. That is not the contention. The contention is: how are you handling what you are getting?

In this last seeking time, God showed me something I did not know. He said, "You still have some pride and exaltation left."

I was esteeming myself in my own estimation. You know, legend-in-your-own-mind syndrome. I may deserve better treatment than I have been getting. I may have deserved it. But when I think I am in an exalted position, I start turning toward that person with animosity.

I may take the surface level of the Word and say, "Yes, I forgive them," and get very pious and fold my hands. When important people are around, I confess that Word and humbly say, "Yes, oh yes, I love them. I have forgiven them."

We cover it up from the surface. But what we do is cover it up and keep driving it in deeper. It starts cutting little words, subconsciously affecting the person's attitude. This is why He keeps saying in verses like the one we are going to read, "If you do not forgive every one of your brothers his trespasses from your heart."

From your heart. From your heart. Every one of his brother's trespasses from your heart. He says your heavenly Father cannot forgive yours.

I got to thinking about some things people had done to me, and I got real angry. They had not done anything to me recently, but I got angry. He was showing me how much stuff I had not driven out yet. It was subconscious, if you will allow me, a heart effect on your mind and your attitude toward a person.

If He can really purge these things off and out of me, I want them off and out.

I am here to testify to you firsthand that He can. He not only can, He will. He not only can and will, but He makes it a priority in every believer's heart because Jesus said, "By this shall men know that you are My disciples, that you love one another."

I think what the world is looking for more than anything else is unconditional love.

I was so proud of myself this time. We sent my two-year-old German shepherd in for a spay. She died. The vet made a mistake. No, she died. I really loved her. She was my dog. She fit in my truck.

It was during the time of this last seeking time. The devil tried to get closer, but he could not get any closer. He killed two of our dogs and one of our birds. He could not get any closer.

The vet did not mean to do it. Anyway, she still died. She never came home.

I was pretty proud of myself because I did not even want to sue him. The only thing I thought of was how to turn that situation into an opportunity to witness to the man. I can assure you, he expected a lot worse.

Now I can go into his office, and I have the upper hand. I can say, "Sir, I am not going to do anything. I do not want any retribution, and I will take my new little German shepherd in to you to get her shots. I will. The reason I will do all of that is for a chance to testify. I want you to know why I will never do anything to you: because it would have destroyed any chance that you would ever receive the gospel from me. I want to tell you about Someone who has so changed my life."

I want it all out. I found out that when I cannot forgive somebody totally from my heart, it is a subtle form of self-exaltation because I believe I deserve much better treatment than that.

And you may. Whether you do or not, my friend, He still said all trespasses. He said from your heart. And from your heart is an emotional realm.

This is my advice to you: you had better enter into the power of the Holy Spirit and fight that unforgiveness until your emotions have turned loose of it. Meanwhile, you had better stand up and confess the Word of God over them and shut your mouth. You had better walk in your outward actions as though you are already healed while you are working on the hard part.

That way the devil will not know whether all that junk he threw at you is still working.

Is it worth fighting for? It is the worthiest thing to fight for that has thus far been delivered to me in the gospel. It is undoubtedly a result of that peace that keeps unfolding into wonderful things as I bring my life more and more under subjection, as you should, to the Prince of Peace, the Lord Jesus Christ.

I am not sure I am experiencing all of it, but I can say this: it is a very strange and wonderful feeling. At least at this point, I believe I have forgiven everyone from my feelings. Strange and wonderful feeling. It feels like I have opened some kind of mountain of faith.

"From your heart?"

Yes.

Obviously, you are heading somewhere. You bet.

Looking at Matthew 18:35:

So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

The word "like" means He is comparing you to something He has already said, and "wise" means you had better be wise enough to conform to it. So He says:

So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

How many? Did that say two thirds? Come on, can't we just leave one or two people out of this? It feels good to hate a little. How about nine tenths? All right, we will go down into decimals. How about point five?

Talking about it is the easy part. Nevertheless, He said, "So likewise shall your heavenly Father do to you, who forgives not every one, every one, their trespasses."

Have you ever seen a trespass sign hanging? When I was a kid, there was a pond with "No Trespassing" signs all over it. But do you think that would stop a kid? I could not help it. I dragged that old fishing pole out and dug some worms. I snuck through the barbed wire fence.

You know the feeling. I was fishing away and catching bass. All of a sudden I heard, "Hey, what are you kids doing?"

Boom. My hair stood up on end. I dropped my fishing pole and lost it, because when I snuck back later it was gone. Boy, you want to talk about running. I nearly lost my clothes on that barbed wire fence.

The sign said, "No Trespassing." I violated that man's territory.

A person cannot trespass against you unless they violate you. They do something to you that is wrong by anyone's standards. They have trespassed.

Now He said to forgive everyone their trespasses from your heart.

I said that even the lusts of the flesh and these kinds of things, God will walk through hell with you on them. It is not even until a man hypocritically begins to judge his brother in unforgiveness for what he himself is guilty of that God allows judgment on your lusts of the flesh.

It hinges around unforgiveness, because unforgiveness is a violation of the very principles of unmerited, unearnable mercy and grace that you were born again by. Men did not deserve what He did for them. If you want His best, unforgiveness is a violation of grace. That is why it is so devastating. That is why He says, "from your hearts."

Can you prove that to me? Definitely.

Back up a few verses. I was not intending on getting into this chapter, but just a few verses. How about verse 21:

Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord, how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? till seven times?

Sounds like some of you. "How about seven times?"

Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.

In other words, "Peter, my God, you have missed the whole point of the teaching. I do not say seven times. How about seventy times seven? How about four hundred and ninety times a day?"

Peter missed the whole thing. Because he missed it, Jesus had to give him a parable, a certain teaching. He had taught in intricate detail up to verse 21, and Peter still jumps in and says, "How many times am I supposed to do this?"

Jesus says, "Oh, my God, Peter, you missed it. Now I am going to have to give you a parable. I am going to have to give you something you can understand with your natural mind to illustrate this spiritual principle. Do you not know that salvation, the whole universe, everything, revolves on this principle? It is not a law."

That is why He did not say seven times. He said seventy times seven, four hundred and ninety a day, because it is not a law; it is a principle.

Jesus said:

Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.

Now He is going to compare the kingdom of heaven and its operation to this king. You and I have no trouble understanding kings, operations, and principles in the natural.

And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents.

How about twenty million? Where is a servant going to get twenty million?

But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

The servant fell down and worshiped him, saying:

Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.

Then the lord of that servant was moved with compassion. Notice this:

And loosed him, and forgave him the debt.

He loosed him and forgave him. This is where He started opening up, "forgive every man from his heart." It is more than an attitude. The king not only loosed him, but forgave him. When we get to where we can break this down, it is heavy. It goes deep, that you can set a man free.

But right now we are after something else.

The same servant went out and found one of his fellow servants who owed him a hundred pence, about ten dollars. He laid hands on him, took him by the throat, and said, "Pay me all that you owe me."

His fellow servant fell down at his feet and said, "Have patience with me, and I will pay all to you."

But he would not. He went and cast him into prison until he should pay the debt.

When his fellow servants saw what was done, they were very sorry and came and told their lord all that had been done.

Then his lord called him and said:

O thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all that debt, because thou desiredst me:
Shouldest not thou also have had compassion on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity on thee?

"I not only forgave you, I loosed you from it, my friend."

And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.
So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

Because we are really only after one thought out of this chapter, we had better think about it real heavily.

Jesus gave the most tremendous teaching in the entire Word of God on forgiveness and loosing and what makes faith work up to verse 25. Trust me, we are going to get into it like we never have before.

This is God. We have a people that is praying now. We are just starting to see the most wonderful things take place as a result of that prayer. Wonderful things. But it seems that the things that bring the most results are the least taught.

I wonder why.

What He told me a couple of weeks ago is why.

Thank God for the capacity of a believer, to whom He said all things are possible. We are talking dreamland here. How can He say things like He said in Matthew 17, that if you can deal with this kind of unbelief, you can move the tree into the ocean? He said, "Nothing shall be impossible to you."

To who? The man who dealt with that certain kind of unbelief.

Nevertheless, this realm of faith is available to the believer.

In my first years of being programmed to faith, those were the most exciting years, realizing the potential of a believer: me and you, His righteousness, our potential. My God, I got so excited about the potential that I skipped the whole alphabet and dragged Z out.

Not only did I attempt to operate in Z, I attempted to get everyone I preached to to operate in Z.

How about A, B, C, D, E, F, G? Skip it. Let us all go to Z.

What does Z entail? I painted a picture of the mountain and said, "You can move it." Of the sycamine tree: "You can move it." I would paint the same picture week after week.

Holy Ghost, move on me.

But I found out that if I dangle the mountain in front of you and all that wonderful potential - that you are a millionaire, you are a miracle worker, you are a mighty man of God, you are a prophet - it does not matter that you are working minimum wage and cannot believe for a car. You are going to go out and win this whole nation day after tomorrow.

By dangling the mountain, we kept the excitement so high that everybody would run back the next day reaching for the mountain. We would dangle it the next day, and everybody would run back reaching for it. We lived in a state of excitement reaching for the mountain.

After a while, five years can go by, and you realize you have reached for five years and taken the long path.

If there is a short path, what is it?

If you have any trespasses, forgive them so your heavenly Father can forgive you.

Jesus undoubtedly did one of the greatest teachings on faith up to verse 25. My God, it is tremendous. You ought to go through it and start meditating on it, because we are going to get into it.

Peter missed it. Of course, he was famous for that, was he not?

He said, "How many times am I supposed to forgive my brother?" He wanted the minimum. The trespass was undoubtedly over money. It was in Luke 14, so it probably was in Matthew 18. Peter was very quick to jump in: "How many times am I supposed to?" He stretched everything out as far as he could.

"How about seven?"

Jesus said, "Peter, I do not say seven. I say seventy times seven."

I can just see Peter counting down: "Okay, this is the four hundred and eighty-ninth time I have forgiven you. I only have one more to go, and then I am going to collect that past-due fishing bill. Four hundred and ninety. I want you to know that I forgave you four hundred and ninety times for not paying that bill. Are you going to pay it?"

"No."

"Okay. My part is up. I am going to get my lawyer."

Jesus said, "No, Peter. You missed the whole principle."

The whole principle that faith operates by is that we have access by faith into this grace wherein we stand. What is grace? The unmerited, unearnable favor and standing of Jesus bestowed on us. There is only one way to access it, and that is by faith.

Jesus says, "Four hundred and ninety? No, Peter, you missed the whole principle. It is the whole concept and principle of faith accessing grace, which is my standing."

There was a servant. The servant obviously did not have twenty million. If a servant had twenty million, he would have bought his freedom. So it is likened unto Adam, who sold himself and his children. The whole human race was sold into slavery.

The king says, "Sell him into slavery to pay the bill."

The servant says, "No. Have compassion on me."

The good man not only forgave him from the sins, but loosed him from the nature of them. He made him a new creation. He absolutely forgave him and loosed him from a debt he could not pay, a debt that his family and children were sold into slavery over.

Then that man turned around over a lifetime debt. Any debt you incur in this lifetime, in trespasses and unforgiveness, as far as He is concerned, compared to what He forgave you, is a twenty-dollar debt.

The man choked his fellow servant over twenty dollars, bound him, and threw him in prison.

Jesus says, "How can you be loosed from such a horrible debt and hold anything against your brother? Remember this: you did not deserve My forgiveness. The whole principle of faith operates on attaining to this grace. I loosed and forgave you because grace operates in mercy and forgiveness on these principles. How come you cannot turn around and operate in them? You are violating grace."

Therefore, He will turn you over to the tormentors, and the tormentors will put you in a spiritual prison. You will lose what you were trying to hold on to.

I love my wife, my family, my children, and you too much to allow the devil the authority to turn me over to the tormentors and put me in prison.

Do you think that diligently seeking out the inroad to loosing and forgiving from my heart is not worth whatever I need to do in fasting and prayer to arrive at the place where I can forgive you from my heart?

"Why don't you dangle the mountain in front of us? We like it better."

Why don't we take the shortcut? Which one is it? The mountain is the long cut. Forgiveness is the shortcut.

If you major in the minors, you will end up in the majors. If you major in the majors, you will end up in the minors, always reaching and never apprehending.

We have some more I wanted to get into. I can feel I am slipping over into another direction now.

Have you ever wondered what it meant to agree with your adversary, unless the adversary delivers you to the judge? You say, "How can I agree with my enemy and my adversary, the one contending against me?"

It talks about if you have ought, leave your offering at the altar and go straighten it out, because if you do not, it will not do you any good.

This forgiveness has everything to do with the financial realm, more so than any other realm. In reason, we may think that money is based on legalism and law. We call it the law of prosperity. But giving and receiving has more to do with grace than probably any other receiving factor.

That is why all through the Word of God, almost every time He mentions money, He implicitly mentions forgiveness. In the areas of money and offerings, it has more to do with grace and unmerited, unearnable favor than just about any other area.

This is why so many Christians who are manipulated by the power in money are manipulated because of greed and self-exaltation. When forgiveness dominates their soul from their heart, it also releases all those realms and makes them prime prospects for incredible prosperity to meet people's needs.

So just remember, when you are contending for forgiveness, you are not only contending for God's forgiveness because you have totally forgiven. You are also contending for the forces that have more to do with incredible wealth at the hands of God than any other force recorded in His entire Word, because it deals with the root nature of man. As far as money and power are concerned, it deals with the most destructive power.

He said, "From the heart, forgive everyone his brother their trespasses."

That heart statement deals with loosing and forgiving. It is not enough to just fight the mental attitude and say, "Yes, I forgive." There is a loosing involved here.

I do not know if you want to go as far into this with me, but I am going in myself. And I am going to drag you along in teaching.

The reason is that He has made me know beyond any shadow of a doubt that what my heart is like a desert over - wanting that pure, crystal, distilled Holy Ghost realm where He can flow through us and meet people's needs, spirit, soul, and body in every realm - exists in this realm where I am attempting to take you.

As far as forgiveness is concerned, it is in the realm past just forgiveness, in the realm of loosing.

"What do you mean, loose me?"

Well, I do not care. I forgive you. But here is where the heart kicks in: I will mark your bill off. I do not care. I will send it back to you. If you do not want to pay it, do not. Because I know the realm where loosing lies. I also know the power that lies in that realm. And I also know it is a place where the devil will never get me imprisoned.

If he cannot get me imprisoned, there is not a thing this side of hell you can do with me. Every time you think you have a guy like that down, he comes up in the west quarter and conquers again.

When the economy gets to a place where people do not have a red dollar to give you, and the fields are not producing enough food to haul into your city, you thought Calcutta back-alley situations would never touch America. But those conditions can force your heart to harden because your kids are bawling all day long and you only had one bowl of rice to give them.

It is getting rough.

My friend, these conditions exist in Christian camps all over. I am going to tell you what will feed your kids.

Jesus said I do not have to take any thought for what I will eat and the clothing I will wear. I do not have to give it a single thought because His devil-stomping believers are capable of much more, and the Scripture is not limited to any generation, geography, or country.

A Bible will work as good in your lap as in the lap of a twelve-year-old in Calcutta, India, who steps across the verse that says:

Take no thought for what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink, or wherewithal ye shall be clothed.

They can take their stand on it, and He will send you from here to feed them, or an angel will appear. But they will eat. The power of God will work as good in that camp as it works in this camp.

But my friend, I am telling you something. It is these principles that will get you out of prison. It is not whether food is available or not. It is whether the devil can keep you from the food.

Let us take it a step further. If you can believe for food under those conditions, then over here, where you have the food without those conditions, you should be able to believe for more.

Do not let the devil keep you in prison.

"You do not understand. I have to work two jobs to make ends meet."

I do understand. But I am telling you, there is a place in Him where your life can produce much more than payday to payday, much more than nominalism where God is not free to move, much more than disease running its course.

We are talking about a realm where He fills His churches and empties them with born-again, delivered, free people who are on the track of conquering for God.

That place is in Him. I am going in further. I am already addicted to it. He has assured me that all that stuff lies in there: loosing, forgiving, destroying that root in me, ultimate forgiveness.

What a root. Anything that old self-exalted nature can grab onto, especially money.

I do not care. I would like to go down and pay cash for a new car. I would like to do that. I would like better to be able to give a million to the gospel just because I had it in my account.

"Write down a million-dollar check."

"Where did you get it?"

"That has not been much of a problem since God made a funnel out of me."

But notice He said, "from the heart." That is what we are going to be working on. From the heart. From the heart. From the heart. Forgive everyone his brother their trespasses. From the heart. From the heart.

I cannot say it enough.

"So are we going to find out how to do that?"

Yes, we are.

It is kind of like lying. A person will bend the truth just a little because he cannot see what it hurts. It seems like it would cause a whole lot more trouble not to do it. Yet it shows your faith level in the area of believing God could rectify the situation with great victory that would far supersede the temporary results you brought.

We do not do it because we do not really believe that. We have no understanding of truth and the power it carries.

It is the same with extreme forgiveness. It goes past forgiveness to loosing. We do not, and at times cannot, do it because we do not really believe what God could do with the situation if He were turned loose in it.

We do not really believe it. We do not really believe we violate grace when we sit down and build the faults in somebody's character to destructive realms in the presence of other people, instead of doing what Jesus said: pray and help those with faults, considering your own.

But when transformation takes place, that is finally separation from the way the world would handle that situation to the way God would handle it.

That is transformation, my friend.

"Oh, he is full of the Word."

No, no. You are full of the Word only to the degree that it has been allowed to separate you from the world. That is full of the Word.

"Well, they have extreme knowledge."

They may. But being full of the Word is what you choose to operate in.

When we talk transformation, we are talking about the Word separating me into that situation with its power, so that I believe God is in charge of my situation, and that I have been so transformed that I believe if I do not loose you and forgive you from my heart, then I believe what He said: there is a prison.

Some of your bank accounts testify to that prison, and you are too dull to see it.

"Does it mean everyone?"

No, not everybody who has problems with poverty has been put there by unforgiveness. But I am saying transformation takes place when you are separated to believe what the Word says. By golly, it means what it says.

It says your heavenly Father has no choice when the devil challenges Him over your violation of forgiveness. The devil states his case, and God really has no choice but to put you in his custody.

Concerning what? Your money or any other area. He said He put you in prison.

"I do not really believe that."

Well, I did not write it. Either it means it, or it does not. If it does, I suggest you do something with it because it means what it says, and it is the reason for a lot of unanswered prayer.

Nothing will stop the blessings of God faster than a buzzing tongue. Some of us are so held in prison that we do not mind who we talk bad about.

We think we are getting by with it. No. Sometimes giving you money is putting you in prison, not taking it, because it sets you into a self-destruction mode.

That is what He meant when He said:

Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye; and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.

Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine...

You have a big beam in your eye, and your brother has a splinter. When you start judging him for what you are guilty of, that precious pearl from the Word that you violated - which could be that forgiveness and loosing, that you are not to hold ought, yet your heart is full of ought - becomes the pearl you throw before swine.

You see your brother who has ought, so you start judging him.

"Look how judgmental he is. He is full of unforgiveness and hatred."

And you are too.

Instead of helping the guy, which you are unable to do, you come and say, "Let me get that mote out of your eye," while you have a beam in your own. You start telling him everything wrong with him while you have a beam in your own.

Then you have violated the very Scriptures that said to forgive your brother all his trespasses. That becomes the pearl you throw out before swine. The swine tramples it under his feet, and that pearl you violated gives the devil authority to rend you.

That is the prison.